

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Kashif Barlas

Address: 19 Beverley Close Epsom KT17 3HB

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to support the Planning Application (DM2025/01591) which will make excellent use of an old Ambulance Station as a community hub providing some much-needed social services in this local area.

I live a 5 min cycle ride away (or half an hour walk) and, during the last 15 years, I have had to drive to Sutton or Carshalton to worship on Fridays. I am a keen cyclist, I run a cycling club too and it gives me great pleasure to know that I can just cycle or walk to worship rather than add to the traffic or parking congestion on our roads. This hub is nicely tucked away from the main traffic routes and will help me get together with my friends more regularly, we will be able to walk together when suitable and reduce the isolation we all suffer from post-Covid. This is especially helpful for women who just need a space to meet.

As with similar community centres, my wife and I would be able to be involved in organising open-days for all the local community and promote initiatives such as on environmental issues, inclusivity, healthy living and education talks that help the community. This really helps people give back through volunteering and gain a sense of pride in doing something that's appreciated.

I am particularly excited about organising some activities to maintain the garden around the site, regularly before or after worshipping. It's a great way to increase friendships, get fresh air and light exercise, bringing the young and old together.

I noticed the cycle racks and can't wait to promote more cycling in the community.

I humbly request that the council notes my comments of support and approves this application in light of the enormous benefits to the local community.

Your sincerely

Kashif Barlas